

Keyword Search Report

Keyword: "basketball"

- Date: 2026-09-20
- Results Found: 2 matching pages
- Sources: The Financial Express

This report was automatically generated by VEE2 ePaper Intelligence.
Each page below shows the actual newspaper page image, translated headline,
full English article text, OCR confidence score, and source page number.

OCR Engine: RapidOCR + Multilingual Tesseract
Translation: LLM-powered with Named Entity Preservation
Newspapers: DT Next | Lokmat | Loksatta | Financial Express

WORDS WORTH

Decoding the consumer

Peeling away to the core of what drives buying decisions Page 4

WELL BEING

DO SUPPLEMENTS REALLY ADD UP?

Dietary supplements & nutraceuticals are increasingly lining the shelves of our local stores. But are they as unassuming and healthy as they claim to be? Page 9

FE

SUNDAY

NEW DELHI SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 20, 2026

24 Pages, ₹12 (Patna ₹12, Rajpur ₹12, Srinagar ₹12)

FINANCIAL EXPRESS ON SUNDAY

READ TO LEAD

PUBLISHED FROM AHMEDABAD, BANGALURU, CHANDIGARH, CHENNAI, HYDRABAD, KOCHI, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI

Indian basketball all set to have its IPL moment

● League to be an entertainment product, says CEO

KUNAL DOLEY
New Delhi, September 19

THE UPCOMING INDIA Basketball League (IBL) is all set to do with basketball what the Indian Premier League (IPL) did with cricket – build a complete entertainment product around the sport, and not just a professional sporting league, as per Jai Lal Singh, its newly appointed CEO.

“We want every match in our season to be an event. We will feature top artists, up and coming DJs, an amazing hospitality experience, and, of course, a brilliant product. Basketball is an action-packed sport, with many moments for celebration,” said Singh, who joined IBL in July after eight successful years with Rajasthan Royals, where he played a pivotal role in the IPL franchise’s commercial growth, digital expansion and global positioning.

“My experience with Rajasthan Royals taught me the importance of building a strong fan-first culture, creating long-term commercial value, embracing innovation, and investing heavily in talent development. I hope these principles apply just as much to basketball as they did to cricket,” he added.

“IPL succeeded because it built something that its cricket, its India, its fans loved. That’s exactly what we are trying to do with basketball. We want a fan-first culture, creating long-term commercial value, embracing innovation, and investing heavily in talent development. I hope these principles apply just as much to basketball as they did to cricket,” he added.

“The timing of the country’s first professional basketball league – being introduced by the Basketball Federation of India (BFI) in partnership with management company ACG Sports – is significant. Today, basketball is played by over 55 million people in India, and more than 100 million fans engage with the sport. IBL is scheduled to launch its inaugural season in early 2027.

Continued on Page 2

55 mn

Early 2027

● Can push for waivers, but firm on energy security

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 19

US PRESIDENT DONALD Trump has assumed sweeping Congress-backed powers to impose tariffs of up to 100% on the top five buyers of Russian energy by signing the Sanctifying Russia and Iran Act late Friday. This puts India once again on the line of US trade

RUSSIA & IRAN SANCTIONS ACT SIGNED

India faces hefty tariff risk under Trump's new law

● Law to take effect within 30 days

US TRUST to identify countries to be targeted, recommend tariff rates

● Countries to get 180 days to reduce Russian energy purchases or negotiate with US

● But Trump can shorten period, impose tariffs sooner

\$100,000 fee on H-1B visas extended

US PRESIDENT DONALD Trump has extended by a year the \$100,000 fee on employers for bringing in foreign workers on H-1B visas, the White House said. In a presidential proclamation issued on Friday, Trump said the 2025 decision to impose a \$100,000 fee has led to a 97% decrease in H-1B visas.

Govt to land, b worth

FE BUREAU
New Delhi, September 19

THE NATIONAL LAND REVENUE CORPORATION (NLRC) will monetise surplus land building assets valued at more than ₹5,000 crore as the run corporation steps efforts to unlock value underutilised public assets. The proposals were discussed at the 21st meet NLRC’s Board of Directors held on Friday, which reviewed the corporation’s annual performance and financial initiatives. The Board also

Keyword match: "basketball"

...ipur 12, Srinagar 15)

involvingIndiaPage7 PUBLISHEDFROM:AHMEDABAD

PUNE Indian basketball all set to have its IPL moment

League to be TAKINGAJUMPSHOT value, embracing innovation,

Developer and investing heavily in talent

anentertainment development. Thoseprinciples

applyjustasmuchtobasketball as theydoto cricket,"he added.

basketballin India India Basketball League

first professional basketb...

TRANSLATED HEADLINE (English)

PUNE

Full Article Text (English)

Indian basketball all set to have its IPL moment

OCR Confidence: 86% | Source: The Financial Express · Page 1 · 2026-09-20

VEE2 ePaper Intelligence · Automated OCR Report

PM (GST). The
 The Member
 Cut-off Date.
 able by remote
 the register of
 one the EGMs
 es on the Call
 nect a Member
 ntified to vote
 shares held in
 n or may call
 or at C-101,
 res set out in
 Days Limited
 Shivam Kataria
 nance Officer

GTR's Ajay Srivastava said. The textile sector is particularly concerned. "Any additional tariffs under this Act will be

protect its interests. Although China buys more Russian crude than India, New Delhi has previously faced Russia-related

protect India from future US action under Section 301, sectoral tariffs or other trade laws," he added.

already in the United States on student visas, who make up a large share of new H-1B recipients, or to renewals of

employers' recent or planned layoffs of similarly situated US workers when considering H-1B visa applications.

0% chance of AI ending the world: Nvidia's Huang

"There is 0% chance that's going to be the end of the world," he said. Huang believes the artificial intelligence (AI) industry needs to push ahead with development keeping safety of products in mind.

"We should go as fast as we can irrespective of anybody else...We're going to go as fast as we can, but we would never ever, and never should, ship products before they're ready, deliver products that are unsafe...And

But everybody's expecting us to succeed and help America be as prosperous as possible," he said.

industry after Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei advocated for slowing down the pace of AI model development saying that if unchecked this could outrun human ability to control such systems.

Why facelifts can no longer save sedans

Gaurav Vangaal, associate director, LVP forecasting, Mobility Global, told FE that despite facelifts, it is tough for sedans to make a comeback. "It has been a trend that sales marginally rise for a few months with each new launch/ facelift of a sedan – as we saw with the all-new Hyundai Verna way back in 2023, and before that in 2022 when Skoda introduced the Slavia and Volkswagen launched the Virtus, but then they eventually taper," Vangaal said. "The market has wholly shifted to SUVs, and midsize sedans, in

But in this segment, there is an outlier. Among the 286,268 total sedan sales between January and August, Maruti Suzuki's Dzire has sold 168,413 units, and is on track to become India's single largest-selling PVE in 2026. But remove the Dzire, and the rest of the sedan market has collapsed. Among entry-level sedans, the Hyundai Aura has sold 49,517 units, the Honda Amaze 26,676 units, and the Tata Tigor 7,504 units. Among midsize sedans, the Virtus has

This decline is rooted in a fundamental shift in consumer preference towards high driving positions, commanding road presence, and high ground clearance. Entry-level buyers who once upgraded to midsize sedans are now jumping straight to compact crossover SUVs — a shift that claimed its first major casualty last year when Maruti Suzuki discontinued the Ciaz after its FY26 sales plummeted to just 1,980 units.

Indian basketball all set to have its IPL moment

Six participating cities have already been announced. ACG Sports will own and operate all the six teams for the first couple of years to keep quality and standards consistent.

IBL is aiming to deliver an aspirational, premium and highly entertaining sports experience from its very first season. On the court, fans can expect a compelling mix of India's top talent and international stars. Off the court, the focus will be on high-quality production, engaging storytelling and digital-first fan experiences. "Whether you are in the arena or following the action through streaming or broadcast, IBL will be exciting, accessible, and really premium," said McCrum.

According to McCrum, what excites him most, however, is the role fans will play in building this league. "From helping determine which cities take the court in Season 1 to influencing team identities and contributing in community initiatives, this isn't a league being handed to fans fully formed. It's a league being built with them, from the



very beginning," he added.

In terms of sponsorships and commercial partnerships, discussions are progressing strongly. "At this stage, what I can say is that we are seeing strong interest from brands that understand the huge potential of basketball and youth culture in India. Announcements are coming soon," McCrum said.

According to him, if a league is going to be sustainable, it must invest in the product. "We have done exactly this by investing in the foundation first — a state-of-the-art high-performance centre (in Bengaluru) providing elite training and world-class

infrastructure to the best

The IBL comes at a time when many non-cricketing

The Pro Kabaddi League (PKL), which premiered in 2014, for instance, is now the second most watched sports league in India after the IPL. Other sporting leagues

creating waves include Indian Super League (ISL), Women's Premier League (WPL), Prime Volleyball League (PVL), Ultimate Kho Kho (UKK), Ultimate Table Tennis (UTT), Global Chess League (GCL) and Pro Panja League (PPL).

Just to get a sense of their popularity – the inaugural season of PKL was seen by 435 million viewers, second only to the 2014 IPL's 552 million, while the first season final between Jaipur Pink Panthers and U-Mumba was watched by 86.4 million.

Similarly, the ISL – the sole recognised top-tier football league in India – had 157 million unique viewers in 2024-25. The inaugural edition of Women's Premier League, meanwhile, in 2023 hit 50.8 million viewers in the first week and 67.8 million TV reach in the first 14 matches; and in 2024 hit 103 million TV reach in the first 15 games, as per a 2025 KPMG-Sportstar report.

In October, India is hosting the World Armwrestling Championship, which will give

the country's Pro Panja League (PPL) a shot in the arm. Started by actor-couple Parvin Dabbas and Preeti Jhangiani, PPL has had two seasons so far — New Delhi in 2023, and Gwalior in 2025. McCrum clarifies at the outset that their ambition is *not to copy the IPL, but to "build the best basketball league for India and the broader Indian diaspora"*.

"What excites me is that basketball is already a truly global sport," says IBL's CEO, John McCreum. "For young audiences, is digital first, culturally relevant and fast-paced. These characteristics align exceptionally well with India's demographics. If we consistently deliver a great product, create stars and engage fans authentically, there's absolutely no reason why IBL can't become one of India's biggest sporting properties over time," he added. According to McCreum, IPL didn't succeed because it copied another league — it succeeded because it built something that fits cricket, fits India, fits the moment. "That's exactly what we are trying to do with basketball," he added.

- **Keyword match: "basketball"**

...REGARDING THE CORRIGENDUM TO THE NOTICE OF 78TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING ("AGM")

Indian basketball all set to have its IPL moment

The Company had issued a Notice dated August 27, 2026, convening the 78th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of Novartis India Limited (the Company), scheduled to be held on Thursday, September 24.

Six participating cities have creating waves include Indian

2026, at 11:00 A.M. (IST) through Video Conf...

☐ TRANSLATED HEADLINE (English)

Indian basketball all set to have its IPL moment

[Full Article Text \(English\)](#)

The Company had issued a Notice dated August 27, 2026, convening the 78th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of Novartis India Limited (the Company), scheduled to be held on Thursday, September 24.